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In-band DSP management interface

Abstract

In an optical communication system, a high-speed data interface to an optical module can be configured from the module's host-side interface and line-side interface. These module interfaces can be configured with an integrated digital signal processor (DSP) having a DSP microcontroller unit (MCU) as a high-speed in-band DSP management interface. The DSP MCU can communicate to either a host MCU in a host switch/router via the host-side interface or to an external device through the optics hardware via the line-side interface. The present invention provides for systems, devices, and methods using this interface for numerous module DSP-related applications, such as firmware upgrades, management data, diagnostic/telemetry streaming, encryption key programming, and the like.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present disclosure is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/730,770 filed on Mar. 28, 2023. The entire disclosure of the application referenced above is incorporated herein by reference.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

(1) The present invention generally relates to communication systems and integrated circuit (IC) devices. More specifically, the present invention provides for an in-band digital signal processor (DSP) management interface.

(2) Over the last few decades, the use of communication networks has exploded. In the early days of the Internet, popular applications were limited to emails, bulletin boards, and mostly informational and text-based web page surfing. The amount of data transferred by such applications was relatively small. Today, the Internet and mobile applications demand a huge amount of bandwidth for transferring photo, video, music, and other multimedia files. For example, a social networking platform can process more than 500 TB of data daily. With such high demands on data

storage and data transfer, existing data communication systems need to be improved to address these needs.

(3) Optical communication systems are widely used to address the need for high-speed data transfer. However, as optical modules become more complex, more firmware is needed to provide for module features, and more complex feature sets continue to be developed. The currently available interfaces for module/DSP management are not designed for high-speed data communications. Furthermore, conventional interfaces require tunneling infrastructure through the module microcontroller to access the DSP, which increases complexity and degrades the transfer speeds.

(4) There have been many conventional types of methods and systems for a DSP management interface. Unfortunately, they have been inadequate to address the growing need for high-speed data transfer. Therefore, improved communication systems and methods for DSP management are highly desired.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

(5) The present invention generally relates to communication systems and integrated circuit (IC) devices. More specifically, the present invention provides for an in-band digital signal processor (DSP) management interface. Merely by way of example, the present invention is applied to an optical communication system. However, the present invention has a much broader range of applicability, such as other cabling systems, wireless systems, baseband systems, and the like.

(6) In an example, the present invention provides a communication system configured with a high-speed in-band DSP management interface. The system can include a host device and a module device. The host device can include a host microcontroller unit (MCU) coupled to a switch device. The module device can include an integrated digital signal processor (DSP) coupled to a communication device. This integrated DSP includes a DSP coupled to a DSP MCU. The module device also includes a module host-side interface and a module line-side interface, which are configured as a high-speed in-band DSP management interface to the integrated DSP. The DSP MCU is configured to communicate with the host MCU through the switch device using the module host-side interface. And, the communication device is configured to communicate via a communication channel using the module line-side interface.

(7) In a specific example, the host device is a host switch or host router and the switch device is a switch application specific integrated circuit (ASIC). The communication device can include an optics device, a wireless device, a baseband device, a transceiver device, or the like. Also, the integrated DSP can include a MAC client configured to the high-speed in-band DSP management interface.

(8) In a specific example, the host MCU is configured to send a firmware image to the integrated DSP using the module host-side interface. And, the DSP MCU is configured to install the firmware image in the module device. Also, the DSP MCU and the host MCU can be configured to communicate using the module host-side interface for management data, encryption key setup, encryption statistics, or the like.

(9) In a specific example, the DSP includes a decoder coupled to an elastic FIFO coupled to an encoder. The DSP MCU is configured to extract one or more data packets from the decoder or inject one or more data packets to the encoder. Also, the DSP includes a capture engine coupled to the DSP MCU and configured to exchange diagnostic information. In a specific example, the DSP MCU is configured to communicate diagnostic information to a diagnostics platform over the communication channel with the communication device using the module line-side interface. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives to the system above.

(10) In an example, the present invention provides for a method of operating a communication system for host-to-DSP packet movement. The method includes sending, by a host MCU within a host device, one or more first data packets to a switch device within the host device. The one or

more first data packets can be characterized by a datagram. The method also includes sending, by the switch device, the one or more first data packets to a DSP of an integrated DSP within a module device over a high-speed in-band DSP management interface. This interface is configured from a module host-side interface and a module line-side interface of the module device. Further, the method includes sending, by the DSP, the one or more first data packets to a DSP MCU of the integrated DSP.

(11) The method can further include receiving, by the switch device, one or more second data packets from at least a port within the host device. The method can also include sending, by the switch device, the one or more second data packet to the DSP of the integrated DSP over the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. And, the method can include sending, by the DSP, the one or more second data packets to a communication device of the module device. Further, the method can include sending, by the communication device, the second plurality of data packets to a remote destination via a communication channel. In a specific example, the switch device interleaves the one or more first data packets and the one or more second data packets.

(12) In an example, the present invention can provide a method of operating a communication system for DSP-to-host packet movement, which can be configured with the host-to-DSP packet movement method above. The method can include sending, by the DSP MCU of an integrated DSP within the module device, one or more first data packets to a DSP of the integrated DSP. These one or more first data packets can be characterized by a datagram. Also, the method can include sending, by the DSP, the one or more first data packets to the switch device within the host device over the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. Further, the method can include sending, by the switch device, the one or more first data packets to the host MCU within the host device.

(13) The method can further include receiving, by the communication device within the module device, one or more second data packets from a remote destination via a communication channel. The method can also include sending, by the communication device, the one or more second data packets to the DSP of the integrated DSP. Also, the method can include sending, by the DSP, the one or more data packets to the switch device within the host device over the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. Further, the method can include sending, by the switch device, the one or more second data packets to at least a port within the host device. In a specific example, the DSP can interleave the one or more first data packets and the one or more second data packets.

(14) In specific examples of the methods above, at least one of the one or more first data packets and the one or more second data packets can be encapsulated using an Ethernet framing, TCP/IP framing, an SSH protocol, or the like. Or, at least one of these can include a security layer, such as MAC address obfuscation, CRC calculation obfuscation, or the like. Also, the datagram can include one of the following: a write request datagram, a write response datagram, a read request datagram, a read response datagram, a command request datagram, a command response datagram, an encryption key setup request datagram, an encryption key setup response datagram, an encryption status read request datagram, an encryption status read response datagram, or the like. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives to the methods above.

(15) In an example, the present invention provides a method for operating a communication system for diagnostic streaming. The method includes sending, by the DSP MCU, one or more first data packets to the DSP. The method also includes sending, by the DSP, the one or more first data packets to the communication device using the high-speed in-band DSP management interface configured from a module line-side interface of the module device. Further, the method includes sending, by the communication device, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics platform over the communication channel. In a specific example, the one or more first data packets are characterized by a diagnostic stream datagram.

(16) In a specific example, sending the one or more first data packets to the diagnostics platform includes sending, by the communication device, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics

communication device of the diagnostics platform. This step also includes sending, by the diagnostics communication device, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics DSP of the diagnostics platform. Also, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics DSP, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics field programmable gate array (FPGA) of the diagnostics platform, the diagnostics FPGA being configured by a diagnostics software. Further, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics FPGA, the one or more first data packets to a computing device running a diagnostics software.

(17) The method can further include receiving, by the communication device, one or more second data packets from the diagnostics platform over the communication channel. In a specific example, the one or more second data packets from the diagnostics platform are characterized by diagnostic control datagram. The method can also include sending, by the communication device, the one or more second data packets to the DSP using the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. Further, the method can include sending, by the DSP, the one or more second data packets to the DSP MCU.

(18) In a specific example, receiving the one or more second data packets from the diagnostics platform includes sending, by the computing device running the diagnostics software, the one or more second data packets to the diagnostics FPGA. This step also includes sending, by the diagnostics FPGA, the one or more second data packets to the diagnostics DSP. Also, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics DSP, the one or more second data packets to the diagnostics communication device. Further, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics communication device, the one or more second data packets to the communication device of the module device over the communication channel. Of course, there can be variations, modifications, and alternatives.

(19) Many benefits are recognized through various embodiments of the present invention. Such benefits include a system/device architecture and method of operation for the improved high-speed in-band data interface for DSP management. This high-speed in-band data interface can be used for firmware upgrades, management data, diagnostic/telemetry streaming, encryption key programming, and other applications as well.

(20) The present invention achieves these benefits and others in the context of known data transmission and optically amplified technologies. However, a further understanding of the nature and advantages of the present invention may be realized by reference to the latter portions of the specification and attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) The following diagrams are merely examples, which should not unduly limit the scope of the claims herein. One of ordinary skill in the art would recognize many other variations, modifications, and alternatives. It is also understood that the examples and embodiments described herein are for illustrative purposes only and that various modifications or changes in light thereof will be suggested to persons skilled in the art and are to be included within the spirit and purview of this process and scope of the appended claims.

(2) FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram illustrating a conventional architecture for an optical communication system.

(3) FIG. 2 is a simplified block diagram illustrating a host-side access architecture for an optical communication system according to an example of the present invention.

(4) FIG. 3 is a simplified block diagram illustrating a line-side access architecture for an optical communication system according to an example of the present invention.

(5) FIG. 4 is a simplified circuit block diagram illustrating an integrated DSP according to an

example of the present invention.

(6) FIG. 5A is a simplified flow diagram illustrating host-to-DSP data packet movement in a mission mode configuration according to an example of the present invention.

(7) FIG. 5B is a simplified flow diagram illustrating DSP-to-host data packet movement in a mission mode configuration according to an example of the present invention.

(8) FIG. 6 is a table representing an Ethernet-II packet encapsulation according to an example of the present invention.

(9) FIGS. 7A and 7B are tables representing a write request datagram and a write response datagram, respectively, according to examples of the present invention.

(10) FIGS. 7C and 7D are tables representing a read request datagram and a read response datagram, respectively, according to examples of the present invention.

(11) FIGS. 7E and 7F are tables representing a command request datagram and a command response datagram, respectively, according to examples of the present invention.

(12) FIG. 8A is a table representing a diagnostic control datagram according to an example of the present invention.

(13) FIG. 8B is a table representing a diagnostic stream datagram according to an example of the present invention.

(14) FIGS. 9A and 9B are tables representing a key setup request datagram and a key setup response datagram, respectively, according to examples of the present invention.

(15) FIGS. 9C and 9D are tables representing a statistics read request datagram and a statistics read response datagram, respectively, according to examples of the present invention.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE INVENTION

(16) The present invention generally relates to communication systems and integrated circuit (IC) devices. More specifically, the present invention provides for an in-band digital signal processor (DSP) management interface. Merely by way of example, the present invention is applied to an optical communication system. However, the present invention has a much broader range of applicability, such as other cabling systems, wireless systems, baseband systems, and the like.

(17) As explained above, optical modules are becoming increasingly complex and are requiring more firmware to provide for increasingly complex feature sets. The currently available interfaces for module/DSP management are not designed for high speed data communications. For example, MDIO 4 MHz provides about a 1 Mbps maximum throughput, and I2C 1 MHz provides about a 500 Kbps maximum throughput. Conventional interfaces also require tunneling infrastructure through the module microcontroller to access the DSP, which increases complexity and degrades the above-mentioned speeds. Other management interfaces have been proposed (e.g., I3C (10-20 MHz), SGMII Ethernet-like, etc.), but such interfaces tend to add additional complexity or have other tradeoffs.

(18) However, a high-speed data interface to the optical module can be configured from the module host and line interface (i.e., an in-band module interface). In an example, the present invention provides for systems, devices, and methods using such a high-speed in-band interface for numerous module DSP-related applications.

(19) The following description is presented to enable one of ordinary skill in the art to make and use the invention and to incorporate it in the context of particular applications. Various modifications, as well as a variety of uses in different applications will be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the general principles defined herein may be applied to a wide range of embodiments. Thus, the present invention is not intended to be limited to the embodiments presented but is to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and novel features disclosed herein.

(20) In the following detailed description, numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a more thorough understanding of the present invention. However, it will be apparent to one skilled in the art that the present invention may be practiced without necessarily being limited to these

specific details. In other instances, well-known structures and devices are shown in block diagram form, rather than in detail, in order to avoid obscuring the present invention.

(21) The reader's attention is directed to all papers and documents which are filed concurrently with this specification and which are open to public inspection with this specification, and the contents of all such papers and documents are incorporated herein by reference. All the features disclosed in this specification, (including any accompanying claims, abstract, and drawings) may be replaced by alternative features serving the same, equivalent or similar purpose, unless expressly stated otherwise. Thus, unless expressly stated otherwise, each feature disclosed is one example only of a generic series of equivalent or similar features.

(22) Furthermore, any element in a claim that does not explicitly state “means for” performing a specified function, or “step for” performing a specific function, is not to be interpreted as a “means” or “step” clause as specified in 35 U.S.C. Section 112, Paragraph 6. In particular, the use of “step of” or “act of” in the Claims herein is not intended to invoke the provisions of 35 U.S.C. 112, Paragraph 6.

(23) Please note, if used, the labels left, right, front, back, top, bottom, forward, reverse, clockwise and counter clockwise have been used for convenience purposes only and are not intended to imply any particular fixed direction. Instead, they are used to reflect relative locations and/or directions between various portions of an object.

(24) FIG. 1 is a simplified block diagram illustrating a conventional architecture for an optical communication system. As shown, the conventional optical communication system **100** includes a host switch/router **110** coupled to an optical module **150**. The host switch/router **110** includes a host microcontroller unit (MCU) **120**, a management coprocessor **130**, and a switch application specific integrated circuit (ASIC) **140**. The optical module **150** includes a module MCU **160** coupled to a DSP **170**. The module MCU **160** is also coupled to the management coprocessor **130**, which is coupled to the host MCU **120**. And, the DSP **170** is coupled to the switch ASIC **140**, which has other connections to other components of host switch/router **110**, shown by region **141**. The data path through the host MCU **120**, the management coprocessor **130**, the module MCU **160**, and the DSP **170** is characterized by a management data flow, while the data path through the switch ASIC **140** to the DSP **170** is characterized by a high-speed data flow (shown by the thicker connection line).

(25) In this conventional example, the module MCU **160** is separate from the DSP **170**. The module MCU **160** handles firmware upgrades for the optical module **150**, and the host MCU **120** communicates with the module MCU **160** using a low-speed management interface (e.g., **12C** or **MDIO**). Here, the high-speed data path is not used for any management purpose. Further, there is no access from the line side (i.e., from the optical module **150**).

(26) FIG. 2 is a simplified block diagram illustrating a host-side access architecture for an optical communication system according to an example of the present invention. As shown, the optical communication system **200** also includes a host switch/router **210** coupled to an optical module **240**. The host/switch router **210** includes a host MCU **220** coupled to a switch ASIC **230**. The optical module **240** includes an integrated DSP **250** that is coupled to the switch ASIC **230**, which has other connections to other components of host switch/router **210**, shown by region **231**. Here, the data paths from through the switch ASIC **230** to the host MCU **220** and to the integrated DSP **250** are both characterized by a high speed and management data flow (shown by uniform thickness of connection lines), rather than the separate high-speed data flow and management data flow of the conventional architecture.

(27) In this example, the module MCU is integrated into the DSP **250**. The integrated MCU, referred to as the DSP MCU, handles firmware upgrades and/or diagnostics. The host MCU **220** communicates with the DSP MCU using a high-speed data path (e.g., **100G** Ethernet, or the like) and ensures that sufficient bandwidth is available. In a specific example, the DSP **250** includes a Media Access Control (MAC) client configured on the data path to detect packets with MAC

addresses bound for the DSP **250**. Further, the MAC client can be configured to perform cyclic redundancy check (CRC) functions on such packets, direct them to the DSP MCU, or inject response packets into the data path. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives.

(28) In an example, the system **200** can be configured in a “mission mode”, in which normal traffic is operational. Further details of the “mission mode” configuration are discussed with reference to FIGS. 5A and 5B. In a specific example, a pause methodology (e.g., Ethernet Pause or the like) can also be used for flow control. A pause symbol or packet can be inserted into the data path to stop traffic when the flow from one direction exceeds capacity (e.g., of the internal buffers of a host device, a module, external device, etc.). When capacity is available again, an un-pause symbol or packet can be inserted into the data path to resume the traffic flow again. Of course, there can be other variations modifications, and alternatives.

(29) FIG. 3 is a simplified block diagram illustrating a line-side access architecture for an optical communication system according to an example of the present invention. As shown, the optical communication system **300** includes a host switch/router **310** and an optical module **320**, which can be configured similarly to system **200** of FIG. 2. Similar to system **200**, the optical module **320** includes an integrated DSP **330**. Here, the integrated DSP **330** is coupled to an optics device **340**, which provides a line-side interface.

(30) In an example, the line-side interface can be used for diagnostic testing. As shown, a diagnostics system **301** can include a diagnostics platform **350** with a field-programmable gate array (FPGA) **360** coupled to an integrated diagnostic DSP **370**, which is coupled to a diagnostic optics device **380**. The FPGA **360** provides the interface between the integrated diagnostic DSP **370** and the diagnostic software **302**, which can be running on a computer or other like computing device.

(31) The diagnostics system **301** can be configured to the optical communication system **300** from the line-side through optical module **320**. More specifically, the diagnostic optics device **380** can be coupled to the optics device **340** of the optics module **320** via the line-side interface. Using this interface, the DSP MCUs of integrated DSPs **330**, **370** can communicate diagnostic information and the integrated DSPs **330**, **370** can control the traffic flow between the DSP MCUs through the optics devices **340**, **380**. Further, unlike the conventional architecture, the data path through the optical module **320** to the diagnostics platform **301** and the computing system running the diagnostics software **302** is characterized by a high speed and management data flow.

(32) In an example, the optical communication system can be configured in a “take-over” mode, in which normal traffic is not operational. As applied to the optical communication system **300** in FIG. 3, the interface between the integrated DSP **330** and the optics device **340** (i.e., DSP to line interface) can be taken out of “mission” mode for diagnostic/telemetry streaming. Further details for such streaming telemetry datagrams are discussed in reference to FIGS. 8A and 8B.

(33) FIG. 4 is a simplified circuit block diagram illustrating an integrated DSP according to an example of the present invention. As shown, the integrated DSP **400** includes at least a decoder **410**, an elastic FIFO **430**, a microcontroller **440** (i.e., DSP MCU), an encoder **450**, and a capture engine **470**. As discussed previously, the microcontroller is separated from the DSP in conventional module embodiments, but the present invention integrates the microcontroller **440** with the DSP to implement an in-band DSP management interface. In an example, the integrated DSP **400** parses incoming traffic (ingress path) through the decoder **410**, determines data packets to be intercepted or redirected, and passes along the remaining packets along through the encoder **450** (egress path). Understanding that there can be variations, modifications, and alternatives to the configuration of the integrated DSP **400**, the present example is discussed in greater detail below.

(34) In an example, the input of decoder **410** is coupled a signal receiver **411** and the output of decoder **410** is coupled to a first finite state machine (FSM) circuit **421**, which is coupled to a first buffer **422** and to a first multiplexor (MUX). In a specific example, the signal receiver **411** can be a

Serializer/Deserializer (SERDES) receiver, or the like. In other examples, the signal receiver **411** can include any circuit elements or configurations known by those of ordinary skill in the art for the input data path, data buffering, bus transferring, and the like. Here, the signal receiver **411** is connected to the ingress data path to the integrated DSP **400**, and the decoder **410** decodes the incoming traffic from the ingress path. Depending on the implementation, the decoder **410** can also include various functionalities, such as PCS ingress processing, symbol decoding, AM decoding, FEC decoding, and the like.

(35) In a specific example, the first FSM circuit **421** is configured as a frame extraction machine, which can perform MAC address matching, redirect certain packets based on a selected criteria, and perform other similar functions. Packets extracted or redirected by the frame extraction machine are sent to the first buffer **422**. The first FSM circuit **421** is coupled to both the control of the first MUX **423** and an input of the first MUX **423**. In a specific example, the first MUX **423** is controlled by the first FSM circuit **421** to handle idle insertion into the data flow. An idle circuit **424** coupled to one of the inputs of the first MUX **423** to generate idle packets to replace any extracted packets. The first MUX **423** outputs to the elastic FIFO **430**, which is configured for buffering the input data flow to the output data flow.

(36) On the end, the output of encoder **450** is coupled to a signal transmitter **451** and the input of encoder **450** is coupled to the output of a second MUX **443**. In a specific example, the signal transmitter **451** can be a SERDES transmitter, or the like. In other examples, the signal transmitter **451** can include any circuit elements or configurations known by those of ordinary skill in the art for the output data path, data buffering, bus transferring, and the like. Here, the signal transmitter **451** is coupled to the egress data path from the DSP **400**, and the encoder **450** encodes outgoing traffic to the egress path. As discussed for decoder **410**, the encoder **450** can also include various functionalities dependent upon implementation. Such functionalities can include PCS egress processing, symbol encoding, AM encoding, FEC encoding, and the like.

(37) A second FSM circuit **441** is coupled to both the control of the second MUX **423** and an input of the second MUX **423**. In a specific example, this second FSM circuit **441** is configured as a frame injection machine for diagnostic telemetry (e.g., injecting packets related to the datagrams shown in FIGS. **8A** and **8B**). A second buffer **442** is coupled to the second FSM circuit **441** to allow for high-speed frame injection. With the second buffer **442**, this frame injection machine can be used for high-speed diagnostics, such as in the “take-over” mode discussed previously.

(38) Also, the second MUX **443** is coupled to the elastic FIFO **430** such that the output of the elastic FIFO **430** is received as an input of the second MUX **443**. In a specific example, the second MUX **443** is configured as a frame insertion/pass-thru MUX, allowing the output data flow from the FIFO **430** to pass through until frame injection machine injects frames for diagnostics. Further, a control circuit **480** is coupled to the first FSM circuit **421** and the second FSM circuit **441**. In a specific example, this control circuit **480** can be configured as a MAC processing engine, which performs CRC generation and checking functions and the like.

(39) The microcontroller **460** (i.e., DSP MCU) is coupled to the first buffer **422** (e.g., frame extraction buffer) and the second buffer **442** (e.g., frame injection buffer). And, both the microcontroller **460** and the capture engine **470** are coupled to a third FSM circuit **461**. In a specific example, the third FSM **61** is configured as a frame injection machine for management information, such as from the DSP MCU in the “mission” mode discussed previously.

(40) The diagnostic capture engine **450** is configured to receive diagnostic information (e.g., status and statistics) regarding various areas of the DSP **400** reported at high-speed. In a specific example, the capture engine **450** collects and formulates the high-speed packets for the frame injection buffer **422**/frame injection machine **441**. A capture engine MUX **451** is coupled to the capture engine **450** and configured to select among a plurality of diagnostic sources within the DSP **400**.

(41) FIG. **4** shows a simplified circuit block diagram managing one direction of traffic flow to the integrated DSP **400**. This diagram can represent the DSP hardware configured to manage host-to-

line traffic (i.e., the “TX” path) or line-to-host traffic (i.e., the “RX” path). Typically, an optical module carries traffic bidirectionally, addressing both the “TX” and “RX” paths. Thus, the present integrated DSP can be expanded to additionally include similarly structured hardware to manage the opposite path as well. Of course, those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives.

(42) In an example, the present invention provides a communication system configured with a high-speed in-band DSP management interface. The system can include a host device and a module device. The host device can include a host microcontroller unit (MCU) coupled to a switch device. The module device can include an integrated digital signal processor (DSP) coupled to a communication device. This integrated DSP includes a DSP coupled to a DSP MCU. The module device also includes a module host-side interface and a module line-side interface, which are configured as a high-speed in-band DSP management interface to the integrated DSP. The DSP MCU is configured to communicate with the host MCU through the switch device using the module host-side interface. And, the communication device is configured to communicate via a communication channel using the module line-side interface.

(43) In a specific example, the host device is a host switch or host router and the switch device is a switch application specific integrated circuit (ASIC). The communication device can include an optics device, a wireless device, a baseband device, a transceiver device, or the like. Also, the integrated DSP can include a MAC client configured to the high-speed in-band DSP management interface.

(44) In a specific example, the host MCU is configured to send a firmware image to the integrated DSP using the module host-side interface. And, the DSP MCU is configured to install the firmware image in the module device. Also, the DSP MCU and the host MCU can be configured to communicate using the module host-side interface for management data, encryption key setup, encryption statistics, or the like.

(45) In a specific example, the DSP includes a decoder coupled to an elastic FIFO coupled to an encoder. The DSP MCU is configured to extract one or more data packets from the decoder or inject one or more data packets to the encoder. Also, the DSP includes a capture engine coupled to the DSP MCU and configured to exchange diagnostic information. In a specific example, the DSP MCU is configured to communicate diagnostic information to a diagnostics platform over the communication channel with the communication device using the module line-side interface. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives to the system above.

(46) FIG. 5A is a simplified packet flow diagram illustrating host-to-DSP data packet movement in a mission mode configuration according to an example of the present invention. As shown, the packet flow diagram **501** starts with the host MCU **510** and other ports on the host **520** (e.g., host switch/router). In this example, the host MCU **510** sends two data packets, **M1** and **M2**, to the DSP MCU **550** of the integrated DSP, while two data packets, **R1** and **R2**, travel from the other host switch ports **520** to a remote destination through the line side optics device **560**.

(47) Following the flow diagram **501**, the data packets from both the host MCU **510** and the other ports **520** travel to the host switch **530** (e.g., switch ASIC shown in FIG. 2). In a specific example, the host switch **530** is configured to implement switch queuing, which allows for packet interleaving if sufficient overall bandwidth is available. The packet interleaving of the data packets from the host MCU **510** and the other ports **520** is shown in flow diagram **501** as the packets move from the host switch **530** to the DSP hardware **540** of the integrated DSP. In this case, the **R1** and **R2** data packets are interleaved between the **M1** and **M2** data packets.

(48) Sufficient overall bandwidth may be attained by restricting the effective traffic rate to reserve a portion of the available nominal bandwidth for packet interleaving. In an example, the host and line systems may configure the traffic stream (e.g., Ethernet traffic stream) to utilize a larger-than-normal Inter Packet Gap (IPG), or the like, in order to reserve sufficient bandwidth. In another

example, the DSP hardware can generate pause frames (i.e., the pause method) to regulate the traffic streams. Those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives.

(49) Once the data packets reach the DSP hardware **540**, the packets (M1, M2) destined for the DSP MCU **550** are separated from the packets (R1, R2) destined for the remote destination through line side optics device **560**. The architecture of the integrated DSP, including the DSP hardware **540** and the DSP MCU **550**, can be similar to that shown in device **400** of FIG. **4**. Those of ordinary skill in art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives to this packet movement method of operation.

(50) In an example, the present invention provides for a method of operating a communication system for host-to-DSP packet movement. The method includes sending, by a host MCU within a host device, one or more first data packets to a switch device within the host device. The one or more first data packets can be characterized by a datagram. The method also includes sending, by the switch device, the one or more first data packets to a DSP of an integrated DSP within a module device over a high-speed in-band DSP management interface. This interface is configured from a module host-side interface of the module device. Further, the method includes sending, by the DSP, the one or more first data packets to a DSP MCU of the integrated DSP.

(51) In an example, the method can further include receiving, by the switch device, one or more second data packets from at least a port within the host device. The method can also include sending, by the switch device, the one or more second data packet to the DSP of the integrated DSP over the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. And, the method can include sending, by the DSP, the one or more second data packets to a communication device of the module device. Further, the method can include sending, by the communication device, the second plurality of data packets to a remote destination via a communication channel. Further details of the datagrams as discussed below.

(52) FIG. **5B** is a simplified packet flow diagram illustrating DSP-to-host data packet movement in a mission mode configuration according to an example of the present invention. The same reference numerals in this flow diagram **502** correspond to the same components shown in flow diagram **501**. As shown, the packet flow diagram **502** starts with the line side optics device **560** and the DSP MCU **550** of the integrated DSP. In this example, the line side optics device **560** receives the two data packets, R1 and R2, from a remote destination to be sent to the other ports on the host **520**, while the DSP MCU **550** sends two data packets, M1 and M2, to the host MCU **510**.

(53) Following flow diagram **502**, the data packets from both the line side optics device **560** and the DSP MCU **550** travel to the DSP hardware **540** of the integrated DSP. In a specific example, the DSP hardware **540** of the integrated DSP is configured to use a DSP buffer to implement packet interleaving if sufficient bandwidth is available (e.g., by using methods of traffic restriction discussed previously). In an example, this buffer can be an elastic FIFO. The packet interleaving of the data packets from the line side optics device **560** and the DSP MCU **550** is shown in flow diagram **502** as the packets move from the DSP hardware **540** to the host switch **530**. Similar to the case shown in flow diagram **501**, the R1 and R2 data packets are interleaved between the M1 and M2 data packets.

(54) Once the data packets reach the host switch **530**, the packets (M1, M2) destined for the host MCU **510** are separated from the packets (R1, R2) destined for the other host switch ports **520**. As discussed for flow diagram **501**, those of ordinary skill in art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives to this packet movement method of operation as well.

(55) In an example, the present invention can provide a method of operating a communication system for DSP-to-host packet movement, which can be configured with the host-to-DSP packet movement method above. The method can include sending, by the DSP MCU of an integrated DSP within the module device, one or more first data packets to a DSP of the integrated DSP. These one or more first data packets can be characterized by a datagram. Also, the method can include

sending, by the DSP, the one or more first data packets to the switch device within the host device over the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. Further, the method can include sending, by the switch device, the one or more first data packets to the host MCU within the host device. (56) The method can further include receiving, by the communication device within the module device, one or more second data packets from a remote destination via a communication channel. The method can also include sending, by the communication device, the one or more second data packets to the DSP of the integrated DSP. Also, the method can include sending, by the DSP, the one or more data packets to the switch device within the host device over the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. Further, the method can include sending, by the switch device, the one or more second data packets to at least a port within the host device. In a specific example, the DSP can interleave the one or more first data packets and the one or more second data packets.

(57) In specific examples of the methods above, at least one of the one or more first data packets and the one or more second data packets can be encapsulated using an Ethernet framing, TCP/IP framing, an SSH protocol, or the like. Or, at least one of these can include a security layer, such as MAC address obfuscation, CRC calculation obfuscation, or the like. Also, the datagram can include one of the following: a write request datagram, a write response datagram, a read request datagram, a read response datagram, a command request datagram, a command response datagram, an encryption key setup request datagram, an encryption key setup response datagram, an encryption status read request datagram, an encryption status read response datagram, or the like.

(58) In an example, the present invention provides a method for operating a communication system for diagnostic streaming. The method includes sending, by the DSP MCU, one or more first data packets to the DSP. The method also includes sending, by the DSP, the one or more first data packets to the communication device using the high-speed in-band DSP management interface configured from a module line-side interface of the module device. Further, the method includes sending, by the communication device, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics platform over the communication channel. In a specific example, the one or more first data packets are characterized by a diagnostic stream datagram.

(59) In a specific example, sending the one or more first data packets to the diagnostics platform includes sending, by the communication device, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics communication device of the diagnostics platform. This step also includes sending, by the diagnostics communication device, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics DSP of the diagnostics platform. Also, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics DSP, the one or more first data packets to a diagnostics field programmable gate array (FPGA) of the diagnostics platform, the diagnostics FPGA being configured by a diagnostics software. Further, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics FPGA, the one or more first data packets to a computing device running a diagnostics software.

(60) The method can further include receiving, by the communication device, one or more second data packets from the diagnostics platform over the communication channel. In a specific example, the one or more second data packets from the diagnostics platform are characterized by diagnostic control datagram. The method can also include sending, by the communication device, the one or more second data packets to the DSP using the high-speed in-band DSP management interface. Further, the method can include sending, by the DSP, the one or more second data packets to the DSP MCU.

(61) In a specific example, receiving the one or more second data packets from the diagnostics platform includes sending, by the computing device running the diagnostics software, the one or more second data packets to the diagnostics FPGA. This step also includes sending, by the diagnostics FPGA, the one or more second data packets to the diagnostics DSP. Also, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics DSP, the one or more second data packets to the diagnostics communication device. Further, this step includes sending, by the diagnostics communication device, the one or more second data packets to the communication device of the module device

over the communication channel. Of course, there can be variations, modifications, and alternatives.

(62) Many benefits are recognized through various embodiments of the present invention. Such benefits include the system/device architecture and method of operation for the improved high-speed data communications interface for DSP management, as shown in FIGS. 2 to 6. This high-speed data communications interface can be used for firmware upgrades, management data, diagnostic/telemetry streaming, encryption key programming, and others.

(63) As discussed previously, the DSP MCU of the integrated DSP provided in integrated DSP of the improved communication system architecture can be used for firmware upgrades. Currently, DSP firmware images can be greater than 2 MB. Over prior interfaces (e.g., I2C or MDIO), the transfer time for such images typically take several minutes or even tens of minutes. However, using the high-speed module host or line interface, the transfer time can be reduced to seconds.

(64) The high-speed interface can be used for management data flow as well. High-end DSPs typically provide features like constellation pull, debug log memory, histogram, etc. These features are data-intensive applications that can be dramatically sped up using the high-speed interface. Further, periodic polling of the module by the host can be dramatically sped up as well.

(65) Also, the high-speed interface can be used for diagnostic/telemetry streaming. The internal memory of the integrated DSP can be sent to an external host for offline diagnostic processing. As shown in FIG. 3, a diagnostics platform can be configured to the line side interface of the optical module, and the DSP MCUs can communicate diagnostic information using this line side interface. Telemetry data from the DSP can also be sent to an external host for diagnostic processing as well.

(66) Further, the high-speed interface can be used for encryption key programming. An encryption use example case is discussed later with respect to FIGS. 9A to 9D. Other benefits and applications will certainly be recognized by those of ordinary skill in the art.

(67) The present invention also provides for various protocols of data packet encapsulation for use with the high-speed interface as discussed previously. The data packets can be encapsulated using framing from Ethernet, TCP/IP, or other higher-level protocols and the like. In the Ethernet framing example, the data packets can use an Ethernet addressing scheme. In a specific example, the packet encapsulation can be an Ethernet II framing with a dedicated EtherType. In the TCP/IP framing example, the data packets can use an IPV4/IPV6 addressing scheme with a dedicated port number. Or, the addressing can be provided a TELNET service, or the like, to request a dynamic port number.

(68) Also, SSH or other higher-level protocols can also be used for enhanced security. Other security features can include MAC address obfuscation or different addressing schemes. The CRC calculation can also be obfuscated, and different formulas can be used for different levels of access. Of course, there can be other variations, modifications, and alternatives to these framing and security protocols. Further, regardless of the encapsulation method and/or security features used, the datagram messages can remain the same.

(69) FIG. 6 is a table representing an Ethernet-II packet encapsulation according to an example of the present invention. As shown in table 600, the packet encapsulation can be defined by field names and descriptions associated with certain byte number ranges in an example Ethernet-II packet. In a specific example, the EtherType can be a proprietary EtherType compatible with the 802.3 protocol. However, those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives to this packet encapsulation example.

(70) In an example, the present invention provides for an example protocol based on a QSFP-DD CMIS I2C protocol. This example protocol assumes a non-guaranteed transmission (e.g., Ethernet or IPG) rather than a guaranteed transmission (e.g., TCIP/IP). By using this protocol, any CMIS-based management can be accomplished, including the CDB (block command) mechanism. FIGS. 7A to 7F show six datagram definitions that can be used under this example protocol. These datagrams can be defined by field names and descriptions associated with certain byte number

ranges in an example data packet, as further discussed below.

(71) FIG. 7A is a table representing a write request datagram according to an example of the present invention. This datagram of table **701** is sent from the host to the DSP to send data to the DSP. FIG. 7B is a table representing a write response datagram according to an example of the present invention. This datagram of table **702** is sent from the DSP to the host to respond that the DSP received the data from the write request.

(72) FIG. 7C is a table representing a read request datagram according to an example of the present invention. This datagram of table **703** is sent from the host to the DSP to request data to be read from the DSP. FIG. 7D is a table representing a read response datagram according to an example of the present invention. This datagram of table **704** is sent from the DSP to the host to transfer the requested data from a read request.

(73) FIG. 7E is a table representing a command request datagram according to an example of the present invention. This datagram of table **705** is sent from the host to the DSP to execute a command (e.g., CDB command or the like). FIG. 7F is a table representing a command response datagram according to an example of the present invention. This datagram of table **706** is sent from the DSP to the host to return a response to the command datagram (e.g., CDB response or the like).

(74) Of course, there can be other protocol implementations and datagram definitions. For example, command/response protocols can also be implemented similarly to the 300-pin MSA I2C interface. Any of the datagram fields can be removed, reordered, expanded, or shortened. Different fields may also be added depending on the specific application. All such variations, modifications, and alternatives will be recognized by those of ordinary skill in the art.

(75) In an example, the present invention provides for an example protocol for line-side debugging. In this case, a DSP API command can be sent to place the DSP into a 'line-side debugging mode' (e.g., similar to enabling a PRBS generator/checker). This command may involve disconnecting the host interface from the line-side interface and allowing a line-side debugging system to take over (e.g., "take-over" mode shown in FIG. 3). In another example, the line-side debugging system may operate concurrently with the host-side management controller. In this case, the host controller may selectively configure any number of control and/or debug features to be accessible from the line-side system, while retaining any number of control/debug features to be accessible only from the host controller. As a security measure, the host may revoke/modify any such permissions at any time. Of course, those of ordinary skill in the art will recognize other variations, modifications, and alternatives to the debugging configuration discussed above.

(76) FIGS. 8A and 8B show two datagram definitions that can be used under this example protocol. Each of these datagrams can be preconfigured on request and then streamed by hardware. Like FIGS. 7A to 7F, these datagrams can be defined by field names and descriptions associated with certain byte number ranges in an example data packet, as further discussed below.

(77) FIG. 8A is a table representing a diagnostic control datagram according to an example of the present invention. The datagram of table **801** is sent from an external diagnostic controller to set up the diagnostic streaming process. FIG. 8B is a table representing a diagnostic stream datagram according to an example of the present invention. The datagram of table **802** is sent continuously from the DSP under test with pre-configured content. In a specific example, the pre-configured content can include a test block of data that is larger than a packet size. Subsequence (SSEQ) numbering can be used to distinguish partial block data depending on how many datagrams are required (e.g., if three datagrams are required for a block, then groups of datagrams for a block can be assigned SSEQ 1-3). The diagnostic host can then reconstruct the whole block out of partial data received via multiple individual diagnostic stream datagrams according to the sub-sequence numbering. Of course, there can be other variations, modifications, and alternatives.

(78) As mentioned previously, the present invention provides for example use cases of encryption that require high bandwidth or low latency access to the DSP. The present in-band DSP management interface can be highly effective in such encryption use cases. In a specific example,

can use the same structure as the CDB request and response datagrams (from FIGS. 7E and 7F) to perform the key setup and statistics reading functions, as shown in FIGS. 9A to 9D.

(79) FIG. 9A is a table representing a key setup request datagram according to an example of the present invention. The datagram of table 901 can be used by the host to send a new key (or list of keys) to the DSP. FIG. 9B is a table representing a key setup response datagram according to an example of the present invention. The datagram of table 902 is sent by the DSP to the host to acknowledge the key setup request.

(80) FIG. 9C is a table representing a statistics read request datagram according to an example of the present invention. The datagram of table 903 can be used by the host to request to read a batch of statistics from an encryption engine. FIG. 9D is a table representing a statistics read response datagram according to an example of the present invention. The datagram of table 904 is sent by the DSP to the host to return the requested statistics. As with the other datagram examples, there can be other variations, modifications, and alternatives.

(81) While the above is a full description of the specific embodiments, various modifications, alternative constructions and equivalents may be used. Therefore, the above description and illustrations should not be taken as limiting the scope of the present invention which is defined by the appended claims.

Claims

1. A communication system comprising: a module device comprising a digital signal processor (DSP) and a DSP microcontroller unit (MCU) coupled to and integrated into the DSP; a host-side interface of the module device, the host-side interface configured to interface the DSP MCU to a host MCU of a host device; and a line-side interface of the module device, the line-side interface configured as a high-speed in-band DSP management interface configured to interface the DSP MCU to a communication device, the DSP MCU configured to stream data via the communication device over an optical communication channel using the high-speed in-band DSP management interface while bypassing the host MCU of the host device.
2. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP and the DSP MCU are integrated into the module device.
3. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP of the module device is configured to receive firmware from the host MCU of the host device via the host-side interface of the module device and wherein the DSP MCU of the module device is configured to install the firmware in the module device.
4. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP MCU of the module device is configured to communicate diagnostic information from the module device to a diagnostic system over the optical communication channel via the line-side interface of the module device.
5. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP of the module device is configured to communicate telemetry data from the module device to a diagnostic system over the optical communication channel via the line-side interface of the module device.
6. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP of the module device is configured to disable the host-side interface of the module device and to communicate with a debugging system via the line-side interface of the module device.
7. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP of the module device is configured to communicate with a debugging system via the line-side interface of the module device and to control access of the debugging system to debug features based on a command received from the host MCU of the host device via the host-side interface of the module device.
8. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP MCU of the module device is configured to communicate with the host MCU of the host device through a switch device, the switch device coupled to the module device by the host-side interface.

9. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the host-side interface is also configured as a high-speed in-band DSP management interface.
10. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the module device is configured to perform firmware upgrade, diagnostic/telemetry streaming, and management operations using the high-speed in-band DSP management interface.
11. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP MCU of the module device and the host MCU of the host device are configured to communicate management data via the host-side interface.
12. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the DSP of the module device comprises a MAC client configured to communicate via the high-speed in-band DSP management interface.
13. The communication system of claim 1 wherein the communication device comprises an optical device, a wireless device, a baseband device, or a transceiver.
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